TripNerd Daytona Beach Reel: script review brief (v6)

You are a senior performance creative director and Reels editor for a premium sports-hospitality brand. Improve the Instagram Reel script below. You cannot see the media, so I describe every file exactly. Use **only** the media listed. Do not invent shots, footage or facts.

1. The client and the goal

- **Client:** TripNerd (@tripnerd). It sells fan-experience packages and corporate hospitality at major sports events.
- **This Reel sells:** TripNerd's Daytona Beach race-weekend trip, February 2027. The exact date and what's included are **not confirmed yet**, so on screen say "Daytona Beach · February 2027" only. No specific date, price or inclusion on screen.
- **Account:** @tripnerd on Instagram, about 4,650 followers. Organic Reel, posting **Sunday or Tuesday, 12–3 PM Central** (when the audience is most active, per Instagram Insights).
- **Audience for this cut:** race fans and friend groups who might book a race-weekend trip together. **Corporate hosts are out of scope here**; they get a separate Reel.
- **What counts as success, in order:** 3-second hold and reach to non-followers; sends (shares by DM); saves; profile visits and follows; enquiries through the link in bio.
- **Reference style (match this):** [Karl: describe the four reference Meta ads: how they open in the first 2 seconds, their pace and cut speed, how the on-screen text looks and moves, the music or sound, their length, and how they end.]
- **Standard to beat:** TripNerd's owner approved a 25-second Reel called "Their Camera Roll". It shows real guest photos from several events as a phone camera roll (grid, tap, swipe, a suite video that "comes alive", event list, brand-blue end card). This new Reel should feel fresh next to it: no grid, no camera-roll interface.

2. Hard rules (do not break any of them)

1. **Real media only.** No AI-generated people, cars, crowds or scenery. No AI animation, interpolation or AI upscaling of the photos. Text and graphics are added in editing.
2. **No third-party marks on screen:** no NASCAR, speedway, sponsor or team logos. Where they appear in a photo, they are hand-blurred or cropped.
3. **No claims without written proof from TripNerd.** Not yet confirmed: seats over pit road for 2027, the hospitality suite, the oceanfront hotel, track access, garage tours. Do not write them as promises on screen. Questions are fine ("Where would your group sit?").
4. **Banned words and numbers:** VIP, best, number-one, guaranteed, star ratings, and any count of reviews, followers or guests.
5. **People:** no identifiable faces without consent. Backs of heads and crowds only. No children.
6. **Truth labels:** footage from 2022 must say 2022; footage from 2024 must say 2024. Photos from 19 Feb 2023 may show their real camera times. Nothing may claim to show something it doesn't (date, place, moment).

7. **Format:** 9:16, 1080×1920, 15–20 s. All readable text between y=288 and y=1344 px (Instagram's interface covers the top and bottom). It must read with the sound off.
8. **Calls to action:** a send-to-a-friend prompt, plus "Link in bio". Use the button wording "Talk to a Nerd" only if TripNerd confirms that page exists. No "DM us" (nobody covers DMs yet).
9. **The race name** ("Daytona 500") goes in the caption only, and only with: "TripNerd is not sponsored by, affiliated with, or a partner of NASCAR or The Daytona 500." On screen, use "Daytona Beach".
10. **Sound:** the real race audio from Videos F and G comes first; licensed sound effects and music only fill gaps, plus the real room tone from Video E. Sound must match the picture: a single car's burnout is not "the field passing", and F/G audio stays on F/G pictures (or bridges into the next beat as a short J-cut or L-cut). Music: only sounds cleared for business accounts (Meta Sound Collection).
11. **One year per story.** Never present footage from different years as one day. The clock may run only over Photos A and B (both 19 Feb 2023). Videos F and G (2024) and Video E (2022) sit outside the clock with their year label on screen, or the clock is dropped. Copy may not say "one race day" if more than one year is shown.

3. The media (this is everything usable)

Photo A, "6:56 PM": real TripNerd photo, camera time 19 Feb 2023, 18:56, 1024×771 web copy.

- Shot from TripNerd's covered seats above pit road at night, under the lights.
- One stock car is doing a tyre-smoking burnout on the front stretch. Officials and crew stand on the grass by the pit wall. The grandstand behind is packed.
- In the foreground, guests are seen from behind (one in a headset). A guest in a red jacket at lower left is holding up a phone, filming the car.
- A Sunoco sign at top left must be blurred.

Photo B, "4:54 PM": real TripNerd photo, camera time 19 Feb 2023, 16:54, 1024×771.

- Wide daylight view from the same covered seats, over the pit boxes during the race. One car is visible on track in the distance; the grandstand opposite is packed.
- Guests sit along a counter with drinks, wearing red scanner headsets, mostly seen from behind (a few in profile at the right edge).
- A team-name banner on the pit-wall fence and a painted track logo must be blurred.

Photo C (do not use): the same burnout moment as A, from slightly lower, no camera time.

Photo D (do not use): a group on the track at the start/finish line at 12:26 PM. It shows apparent minors without consent, a "VIP" credential and third-party logos.

Video E, TripNerd's 2022 suite tour: one continuous handheld 52-second take, 1280×720, 16:9, before the race (the stands are mostly empty). What happens:

- **0–8 s:** TripNerd's white hospitality marquee with a "TripNerd" sign on a white gate; palm planters. Bystanders at the right of frame (crop them out). Possible speech in the audio at 6–8 s.
- **8–28 s:** following a man in a grey top up steel grandstand stairs.
- **28–34 s:** arriving at the top deck.
- **34–48 s:** the view from TripNerd's seats over pit road: pit boxes, crews stacking tyres, mostly empty multi-coloured grandstand seats. A medical vehicle crosses at 37–41 s; tower lettering at 44–47 s; a sponsor sign at 52 s.
- **Audio:** wind and crowd murmur only. No engine sound.

Video F (TripNerd file V05): real TripNerd video, race day 19 Feb 2024, vertical 720×1280, 10.3 s, at night under the lights. Filmed from covered seats above pit road that match Photo A's view (blue canopy edge and steel posts in frame); TripNerd to confirm these are its seats before any caption says so. **Real race audio, loud** (engines and crowd).

- **0–3 s:** steady view down over the pit boxes and crews, with the packed, floodlit grandstand opposite. A spectator's head (from behind) at the lower right.
- **3–5 s:** the camera pans right to follow the field passing on the front stretch (motion blur).
- **5–8 s:** pit lane with crew and officials; a **Sunoco sign on a pole in mid-frame at about 6–8 s** (crop or blur).
- **8–10.3 s:** pans back toward a yellow pit box.
- Pit boxes carry team colours and logos: blur anything readable. Native 720 px wide, so at 1080×1920 it is a 1.5x upscale and slightly soft.

Video G (TripNerd file V06): real TripNerd video, race day 19 Feb 2024, horizontal 1280×720, 8.2 s, in daylight or early evening (sky not yet dark). Same covered seats above pit road as Video F. **Real race audio.**

- **0–2 s:** yellow and blue pit boxes below, packed grandstand opposite; spectators in the foreground seen from behind (one in a red-and-white cap at the lower right).
- **2–3.5 s: the field passes as a pack**, and the camera pans right with it.
- **4–5.5 s:** a Sunoco sign at the top of frame (crop or blur); single cars passing.
- **6–8.2 s:** settles back on the pit boxes.
- Landscape 16:9: in a 9:16 frame use it as a 4:3 or 1:1 crop in the middle band, or a centre crop.

Brand: the real TripNerd logo file; the approved brand-blue end card (gradient from rgb 90,152,234 to 72,132,214); Montserrat type.

Not available: the hotel; any 2023 video; any footage of the 2027 seats or suite. Videos F and G are the only real race motion and race sound, about 18 s in total.

4. The current script (v6, about 16 s, full-screen 9:16)

The real TripNerd logo sits small at top-left, inside the safe zone, from 0 s. One line of text per beat. Year labels appear once per block, not on every beat. Video G is not used (daylight breaks the night look, it is soft once cropped, and a Sunoco sign enters at 4 s).

#	Time	Picture (exact source)	On-screen text	Sound
1	0.0–3.0	**Video F 2.0–5.0 s**: steady view over pit road, then the pan to the passing field (one continuous take). Label "2024"	0–1.5 s: "This is race night, above pit road." 1.5–3 s: "Sound on."	Real Video F audio, the roar building
2	3.0–5.5	**Photo B**: slow push toward the red headsets. Clock "4:54 PM". Label "2023" (once for beats 2–3)	"TripNerd guests. 4:54 PM. Headsets on."	Licensed crowd bed, low
3	5.5–8.0	**Photo A**: a ring on the red-jacket guest's phone. The clock rolls forward to "6:56 PM" (same day as Photo B, so rule 11 holds)	"6:56 PM. Still filming."	One burnout rev and tyre squeal, matched to the car in frame
4	8.0–10.0	**Video F 0–2 s**: night view over pit road and the packed stands. Label "2024"	"Where would your crew sit?"	Real Video F audio, low then rising
5	10.0–12.5	**Video E 0.5–2.5 s**: the TripNerd tent sign, bystanders cropped out (avoids the possible speech at 6–8 s). Label "TripNerd's tent · 2022"	"Race weekends, planned by TripNerd."	Real room tone
6	12.5–16.0	End card, real logo	"Daytona Beach · February 2027" / "Send this to your crew." / "tripnerd.com · Link in bio"	One engine rev from Video F's own audio, then a cut to silence

- **Caption (draft):** "Race night, above pit road. Who's in your crew for February? 🏁" + the race-name disclaimer from rule 9.
- **Needs TripNerd's written OK:** "Race weekends, planned by TripNerd" (assumes the 2027 package exists) and that "Link in bio" opens an inquiry page. "TripNerd guests" is supported by Photos A and B being TripNerd's seats; the Video F seats are unconfirmed, so no line says "our seats".

5. How v6 was graded (independent review)

Scored on the TripNerd 100-point rubric below. History: v2 (still photos, clock jumping back and forth, unconfirmed date) **60** → v5 (real race video, but a blurred first frame and night/day jumps) **73** → v6 **76** ("average, revisions required"). Target: **90+** before it goes to TripNerd.

Category	Points	v6 score	What still holds it back
1. Hook and scroll-stopping power (first 1–3 s)	20	16	Video F is 720p; the opening line is factual, not intriguing
2. Storytelling and retention	15	11	Two blocks from different years (2024 night, 2023 day-to-night) rather than one continuous day

Category	Points	v6 score	What still holds it back
3. Brand recognition	15	12	TripNerd is named at 3 s, but its role (planning the trip) isn't clear until 10 s
4. Emotional appeal and experience	15	11	No consented reaction shot; comfort and hospitality never shown
5. Authenticity and realism	10	8	All real, honest labels; the value line waits on TripNerd's confirmation
6. Visual and audio quality	10	6	Sources are 720p video and 1024-px photos; the photos sit in a 4:3 band
7. Engagement and shareability	5	4	Send prompt plus a question
8. Call to action	5	4	No confirmed inquiry page behind "Link in bio" yet
9. Instagram Reels optimization	5	4	The photo beats aren't full-bleed
Total	**100**	**76**	

Approval bands: 90–100 client-ready candidate · 80–89 good, minor fixes · 70–79 revisions required · below 70 rewrite. **Mandatory:** accurate event details, no misleading claims about TripNerd's offer, realistic visuals, correct branding, no AI-generated glitches.

The reviewer's view on reaching 90: further rewriting is worth about 1–3 points. The rest needs material: original photo and video files (+3 to 4), written confirmation of the 2027 package so the end card can say what's included (+5 to 6), and one consented guest reaction shot (+3 to 4).

6. What I want from you

1. **Diagnose:** in five bullets, where a non-follower would scroll away, misunderstand the offer or forget the brand in v6. Be blunt.
2. **Improve v6** using only the media in section 3 and all eleven rules in section 2, matched to the reference style in section 1. Change only the beats that need it, and say why for each change. Same table format (time, picture with exact source and seconds, on-screen text, sound). 14–18 s.
3. **Score your version** on the 100-point rubric in section 5, category by category, with one line of evidence each. Don't inflate scores or predict views; if a category can't improve without new material, say so.
4. **Two opening hooks** (first 2 s: picture + text + sound) to A/B test against v6's beat 1, at least one using real audio from Video F or G, and why.
5. **Copy:** three caption first lines (under 125 characters, no banned words) and two end-card headlines.
6. **Sanity check:** for every line of your version, check it against the eleven rules and flag anything that needs TripNerd's written confirmation or consent.
7. **Material asks:** list the three pieces of footage or confirmation from TripNerd that would add the most points, with the categories each would lift.

Do not:

- add footage, people, cars or places that are not in section 3;
- promise anything in rule 3, or put a specific date, price or inclusion on screen;

- use the race name on screen;
- present footage from one year as another (rule 11).